YOUR MAP · FOOD STUFF IS BRAIN STUFF

FIND YOUR (HARD) STEP.

Eating takes five steps before the first bite. Most of us find one or two harder than the rest, and it can change day to day. That is brain stuff. Not a character flaw.

for you, or for someone you care for.



ONE PAGE. FIVE STEPS.
one thing to try for yours.

THE FIVE STEPS

tick any that sound familiar, then pick one to start with.

		IT CAN LOOK LIKE	ONE THING TO TRY	
01	**NOTICE** Noticing hunger before it is urgent.	*"Wasn't hungry. Just foggy and cranky."* For some brains, the signal runs quiet.	Eat by the clock, not the signal. Set times for meals and snacks. Something every three to four hours is a good place to start.	☐ THIS IS MINE
02	**CHOOSE** Deciding what to eat.	*"Fridge open. Nothing sounds right."*	Two or three go-to options, decided ahead. The same breakfast every day is fine. Sameness can be a support.	☐ THIS IS MINE
03	**PAUSE** Stopping what you are doing.	*"Just one more. Then it was 3pm."*	A five-minute warning, then a real stop. Save your place first, so coming back is easy. Or eat alongside someone.	☐ THIS IS MINE
04	**PREP** Getting food ready.	*"Too many steps. Crackers it is."*	Keep food that needs nothing doing within reach. Crackers count. On hard days, a ready-made meal still counts.	☐ THIS IS MINE
05	**START** Taking the first bite.	*"It's right there. I still haven't."*	Put it in your hand, not back in the fridge. Start with one bite of something easy.	☐ THIS IS MINE

MY HARD STEP IS

THIS WEEK I WILL TRY

WORTH ASKING EARLY

If food has started to feel frightening, the list of foods keeps getting shorter, thoughts about food or your body are taking up a lot of room, or weight, energy or growth is changing, that is worth a GP visit.

there is no bad enough. you are allowed to start now.

On ADHD medication and eating has got harder? Tell your prescriber. They can adjust things.

TAKE IT WITH YOU

Bring this page to your GP, paediatrician or therapist. Showing them your ticked step, how long it has been hard and what you have tried is a good way to start. Medicare rebates may be available with a mental health treatment plan (often called a mental health care plan) from your usual GP.

ask for a longer appointment.

Filling this in for a child or teen? Tick the step you see most, and try one thing together. *kids, teens and adults all welcome.*

BODY BELONGING
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Book a free 15 minute chat

pull up a chair. no referral needed.

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The five steps are how I explain eating in my sessions with children, teens and adults. The examples on this page come from everyday patterns, never from a client's own words.

Body Belonging acknowledges the Whadjuk Noongar people, Traditional Custodians of the land on which we work, and pays respect to Elders past and present. Sovereignty was never ceded.

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